Unit - 2

From Trade to Territory



Learning Objectives

- To know the rise of the Political Power of English East India Company
- To know the events and impact of Battle of Plassey and Buxar
- To know the Carnatic wars and Mysore wars
- To know the Anglo-Maratha wars
- To understand the growth of colonial army and civilian administration
- To understand the principles of Subsidiary Alliance and Doctrine of Lapse

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Introduction

In the 15th Century, Europe witnessed an era of geographical discoveries through land and sea routes. In 1498, Vasco Da Gama of Portugal discovered a new sea route from Europe to India. The main motive behind those discoveries was to maximize profit through trade and to establish political supremacy. The rule of East India Company in India became effective after the conquest of Bengal. The main interest of the company in India was territorial and commercial expansions.

Establishment of Political Power by the English East India Company

Battle of Plassey (1757)

Alivardi Khan, the Nawab of Bengal died in 1756 and his grandson Siraj-ud-daula ascended the throne of Bengal. The British taking advantage of the New Nawab's weakness and unpopularity seized power. So, Siraj-ud-daulah decided to teach them (British) a lesson by attacking over their political settlement of Calcutta. The Nawab captured their factory at Kasimbazar. On 20th June 1756, Fort William surrendered but Robert Clive recovered Calcutta.

The Black Hole tragedy (1756)

There was a small dungeon room in the Fort William in Calcutta, where troops of the Nawab of Bengal Siraj-ud-daula, held 146 British Prisoners of war for one night. Next day morning, when the door was opened 123 of the prisoners found dead because of suffocation.

On 9th February 1757, Treaty of Alinagar was signed, where by Siraj-ud-daulah conceded



Battle of Plassey (1757)

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